

plugin can be used to convert well-known text from various coordinate reference systems (CRS) into the CRS84 format.

As GraphDB Workbench is also an open source project now, it will help to develop knowledge graph prototypes from the default AngularJS administrative interface. GraphDB also comes with an open source GraphDB.js driver. It is optimised for Node.js and other development frameworks.

Aiven raises US\$ 40 million in funding

According to a report by Data Economy, Aiven, which combines open source technologies with cloud infrastructure, has announced it has raised US\$ 40 million in a Series B funding. This brings the figure of total funds raised to US\$ 50 million. This round was led by Silicon Valley based IVP.

Existing investors like Earlybird VC and Lifeline Ventures; the family offices of Risto Siilasmaa, chairman of Nokia; and Olivier Pomel, founder of Datadog, also took part in the funding. Oskari Saarenmaa, CEO and co-founder at Aiven, said that this investment is evidence of a growing appetite from enterprises for open source data technologies.



Saarenmaa added that Aiven has been able to offer a platform that solves all the complexities of operating these technologies. This will help customers to focus on their business applications and drive their bottomline. With the funding, the company will be able

to expand its product roadmap and work closely with its customers to help them use open source technologies at scale.

Baidu releases open source tool to detect whether people are wearing masks

Baidu has released an open source tool to detect if individuals in crowds are wearing face masks. This release comes when authorities in China have taken big steps to curb the spread of the Corona virus.

A report by Technode says that many cities like Guangzhou and Beijing are enforcing the use of masks in public areas like restaurants, shopping malls, and



public transport. Till now, mask inspections have been mainly manual, making it difficult to identify non-mask wearers in crowds.

Baidu said that the face-scanning model will use artificial intelligence to identify people in real-time who

are not wearing masks or those who are wearing them incorrectly. It added that the system can identify non-mask wearers with 96.5 per cent accuracy. Developers will need a small amount of data to train the tool for their own use.

Baidu also added that the model was trained on a data set of 100,000 faces. The company claims that the system is the first of its kind.

Hyperledger releases version 2.0 of its open source software, Fabric

Hyperledger has released the second version of its open source distributed ledger (DLT) platform named Hyperledger Fabric. This version has new features like decentralised governance of smart contracts and data privacy on a need-to-know basis.



“The release of Hyperledger Fabric 2.0 is an important step forward in the ongoing evolution of DLT, and was developed based on feedback from real-world use, including improved chain code management capabilities and performance enhancements. The Depository Trust and Clearing Corporation’s (DTCC) work with Hyperledger enables us to bring DLT expertise and knowledge in-house while sharing our learnings and progress on enterprise-scale projects with the DLT community,” said Rob Palatnick, managing director and global head of technology research and innovation at DTCC, and also the governing board chair at Hyperledger.

Hyperledger was established in 2015 by the Linux Foundation. It supports different blockchain and DLT projects, and aims to improve system performance and reliability. Hyperledger Fabric is one of its projects. It is a permissioned blockchain with which enterprises can build applications with a modular architecture.

This version of Hyperledger Fabric had added a management process for installing and starting a chain code. This chain code life cycle allows multiple parties to agree on a chain code’s parameters before letting it interact with the ledger. The new version has also added a data privacy feature on a need-to-know basis. Organisations will be able to share private data with members without defining channels for many combinations of members.



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